

Foundations of Survey Design for Official Statistics

Professional Training Manual (Educational Guidance)

This manual is an original educational resource for government officials and public-sector professionals. It is not an official publication of any government institution.

1. Course Overview

Purpose: Build foundational skills in planning, designing and evaluating surveys for official statistics.
Audience: Government officials. Duration: 6 hours. Level: Beginner.

2. Learning Objectives

Explain surveys; identify target populations; apply sampling; compare sampling methods; analyze survey error; design questionnaires; evaluate data quality; plan end-to-end surveys.

3. Course Structure

Modules: Introduction; Survey Objectives; Sampling; Questionnaire Design; Fieldwork & Quality; Processing & Reporting.

4. Module Summaries

Module 1: Surveys vs Census and survey lifecycle. Module 2: Objectives, concepts, variables, target population and sampling frame. Module 3: Probability sampling including simple random, systematic, stratified and cluster sampling. Module 4: Writing unbiased questions, response scales, sequencing and pilot testing. Module 5: Field protocols, interviewer training, non-response and quality control. Module 6: Coding, validation, weighting, estimation and reporting.

5. Practical Exercises

Exercise 1: Define survey objectives and variables. Exercise 2: Select an appropriate sampling method. Exercise 3: Improve poorly written questionnaire items.

6. Case Study

Illustrative district citizen service satisfaction survey: define objectives, design a stratified sample, draft questions, manage non-response and interpret findings.

7. Assessment

Includes MCQs, true/false, short-answer and scenario-based questions with answer key.

8. Final Assignment

Prepare a survey design proposal for a government programme including objectives, target population, sampling, questionnaire outline and quality plan.

9. Glossary

Population, Sampling Frame, Variable, Indicator, Sampling Error, Non-response, Reliability, Validity, Weighting, Enumerator.

10. Quick Reference

Checklist: define objectives, identify population, choose sampling, design questions, pilot test, train field staff, monitor quality, document methods.

11. References

UN Fundamental Principles of Official Statistics; UN Handbook on Household Surveys; OECD Survey Methodology guidance; World Bank survey resources.

12. Verification Notes

Examples are illustrative; departmental procedures and legal requirements may vary by jurisdiction.

Survey Design Workflow

Step	Purpose
1. Define objective	Clarify the policy question
2. Identify population	Specify who is represented
3. Choose sampling	Balance quality and resources
4. Design questionnaire	Measure concepts consistently
5. Pilot test	Identify problems early
6. Collect data	Follow standardized protocols
7. Validate & analyze	Produce reliable statistics
8. Report	Communicate methods and findings transparently